Chapter0

Five Months Before the War End

Across the continent, the Golden Empire had conquered more than half the known world. Its colossal tanks rolled through ruined cities, its bombers darkened the skies, and its golden banners flew over the ashes of nations that had once sworn never to surrender. The resistance was crumbling. One by one, its allies fell silent, its supply lines collapsed, and its remaining airfields became targets for relentless imperial bombardment.

For the rebel air forces, the situation had become desperate.

The latest bombing raid had nearly wiped out their newest aircraft, leaving behind little more than twisted metal, burning hangars, and the shattered remains of what had once been their greatest hope. With another imperial air raid reportedly approaching, the surviving pilots were ordered to prepare whatever aircraft remained operational.

Even the old ones.

Deep inside a battered hangar, beneath layers of dust and years of neglect, stood a fighter that few dared to touch.

Its paint was faded. Its metal skin was scarred by countless battles. Its engine carried a rough, unmistakable growl, and its frame bore the marks of a war that should have claimed it long ago.

Among the pilots, it was known as the Whispering Wing.

They say if you use something hard enough It will come to life.

No one knew where the voice came from.

No one, except perhaps the man who had flown it for years.

He was considered one of the finest pilots the resistance had ever produced, a man whose impossible victories had become the subject of countless rumors. He had returned from engagements that should have been his last, slipped through enemy formations that had destroyed entire squadrons, and survived encounters with imperial aircraft that vastly outclassed his own.

Some called him a genius.

Others called him lucky.

The final battle was approaching. The Empire was preparing another devastating strike, and the remaining rebel pilots were all that stood between the advancing bombers and the last strongholds of their homeland.

For the first time in months, the old fighter was pulled from its shelter and wheeled into the fading sunlight.

The pilot ran his hand along its battered fuselage, brushing away the dust as though greeting an old friend.

"Looks like it's just you and me again," he murmured.